

F A M

Guide for families & testers

For people using the app — not developers. What FAM is, how to start, and what you can do today.

This booklet covers install paths, accounts, your private family space, where to find features, what's new, privacy in plain language, and a short tester checklist.

What is FAM?

FAM is a private app for **one family at a time**. Each family has its own space: shared chat, a diary of memories, tasks, a calendar, photos in a vault, light games, and a home dashboard. Only people who join **your** family with your **invite code** can see that family's content.

How to install the app

- **Android (beta):** You may receive an **APK** file from whoever runs the project. Install it, allow installation from that source if Android asks, then open **FAM**. Your host can share the separate *Beta tester guide* for step-by-step install tips.
- **iOS:** Usually through **Xcode** (developer install) or **TestFlight** once the app is on App Store Connect. Your host will tell you which path they use.

If anything fails at install time, contact the person who shared the build with you.

Accounts: sign in, sign up, and recovery

You can use FAM in either of these ways:

1. **Email and password** — On the first screen, use the segments at the top: **Sign in** or **Create account**.
Create account: enter email and password (at least 6 characters), then create your account. **Sign in:** same screen, choose **Sign in**, then enter your email and password.
2. **Google** — Tap **Continue with Google** and pick the Google account you want to use.

Forgot your password? Choose **Sign in**, enter your **email**, then tap **Forgot password?** You'll get a reset link if that email is registered.

Email verification — If you signed up with **email and password**, you may see a reminder to **verify your email** (before or after you join a family). Check your inbox for Firebase's link, or tap **Resend verification email** if you need a new one. Google sign-in does not use this flow.

Families: create, join, and invite

After you sign in:

- **Create a family** — You pick a family name; the app gives you a **6-character invite code**. Share that code only with people you trust.
- **Join a family** — Enter the code someone gave you, then set how you want your name to appear.

Each account is in **one family at a time** in normal use. Family data (chat, diary, tasks, etc.) is **not** visible to other families.

Leaving a family is available from **My family** in the menu (see below). Read any warning the app shows before you confirm.

Where things live in the app

Bottom tabs (main bar)

Tab	What it's for
Home	Your dashboard: greeting, streaks, quick actions, recent memories, tasks that need you, upcoming events, and optional family announcement (see below).
Chat	Family group chat.
Diary	Family memories (stories); you can add new ones from here or from Home.
Tasks	Chores and to-dos between family members, with points when completed as designed.

Menu (three lines / "hamburger")

Open the **menu** from the top-left on the main screens. From there you can reach things like:

- **My profile** — Photo (when uploads are enabled), display name, greeting, **FAM coins**, and optional **family title** (see below).
- **My family** — Invite code, member list, **home announcement** (whoever edits it), and leave family.

- **Family polls** — Quick votes (two options) for the whole family.
- **Send feedback** — Opens your **email app** with a subject line so you can tell the host what worked or what broke.
- **Timeline, calendar, vault, leaderboard, predictions, games, insights** — Explore memories over time, events, shared media, points, fun guesses, mini-games, and mood-style summaries (depending on what your family uses).

Features you can use today (overview)

These are the main areas families use; not every household will touch all of them.

- **Chat** — Text messages for everyone in the family.
- **Diary** — Longer “memory” posts with mood and optional photos; readable in the diary feed and timeline.
- **Tasks** — Someone assigns a task, someone else completes it; approvals and **reward points** can apply.
- **Calendar** — Shared events.
- **Vault** — Shared media when the build allows uploads.
- **Gamification** — **Points** for activity, a **leaderboard**, and **badges** for milestones (for example stories written or games won).
- **Predictions** — Light “guess what happens” style fun for the family.
- **Games hub** — Mini-games (for example memory and family trivia-style games); some entries may be marked as coming later.
- **Home dashboard** — Pull-to-refresh, quick links to common actions, and summaries like “this week” and “needs your attention.”

Exact labels may change slightly as the app is polished, but the ideas stay the same.

What’s new or improved (recent updates)

These items were added to make the app clearer and more “family-shaped” for daily use:

Clearer sign-in and account help

- **Sign in** and **Create account** are obvious choices on one screen (you don’t have to hunt for “new user” in small text).
- **Forgot password** works from the sign-in flow (email/password accounts).
- **Resend verification email** appears when your email/password account is not yet verified.

Family announcement on Home

- Any family member can set a **short announcement** that appears on the **Home** tab for everyone (for example “Movie night Saturday” or “Grandma visiting”).
- Edit it under **Menu → My family → Home announcement** (tap to edit, save when done). There is a sensible length limit so it stays easy to read.

Family polls

- Under **Menu → Family polls** (and a **Polls** shortcut on Home), you can start a **simple two-option vote** (for example “Pizza or tacos?”).
- Everyone in the family can tap **A** or **B**. Counts update for the family.
- The person who created a poll can **delete** it when it’s no longer needed.

FAM coins and family titles

- **FAM coins** are a light, in-app “thank you” balance (not real money). You earn coins from things like tasks, diary posts, and games, depending on how your family uses the app.
- In **My profile**, you’ll see your **FAM coins** and can pick an optional **family title** from a preset list (for example “Snack captain” or “Story keeper”). Titles show on the **leaderboard** so everyone can see the fun labels.
- Extra **badges** can appear when you hit certain milestones (for example coin milestones on top of the existing point badges).

Send feedback

- **Menu → Send feedback** opens your mail app with a ready-made subject so you can describe a problem or idea. You choose who to send it to (often the person who gave you the app).

Privacy (plain language)

- Your **family’s** chats, diary, tasks, and other family data are meant to be visible **only to members of that family**, not to strangers or other families.
- The **invite code** is like a key: anyone you give it to can try to join—only share it with people you trust.
- If you use **Google** sign-in, Google’s normal account rules apply in addition to FAM.

For technical security rules, the people who operate Firebase for this project rely on the configuration described in the project’s developer docs.

What's still “beta” or evolving

It's normal for early versions to be rough. In particular:

- **Push notifications** may depend on device settings, battery savers, and whether the host has set up server-side automation. You might not get reminders for everything yet.
- **AI-heavy** features (automatic weekly summaries, smart coaching) are **not** promised in the current open-source scope; the app focuses on things families do together manually.
- **Stricter anti-cheat** for points is still a product/engineering topic; treat points and coins as **fun**, not financial value.

If something feels wrong or confusing, use **Send feedback** or tell your host directly.

Quick checklist for testers

1. Install the build you were given.
2. **Sign in** or **Create account**, or use **Google**.
3. **Create** or **join** a family with the **6-character code**.
4. Try **Home** (including **Polls** and any **announcement**), **Chat**, **Diary**, and **Tasks**.
5. Open **My profile** and **My family** once.
6. Send **feedback** if anything breaks or feels unclear.

Your host can share the project's *Beta tester guide* and *Beta release runbook* for install detail and build prep.

Questions?

Ask the **person who shared FAM** with you (the “host”). They can forward technical issues to whoever maintains the Firebase project and the app code.